

明,因此 Homo sapiens 应是“人”的术语说法,引号中内容为解题线索;而本段首句 But 继前两段后亮明作者观点:人类未来无需悲观,故引号中应该要证明“人类前景向好”,[C]、[D]均为否定性内容,而[B]夸大人在星球中的地位,与“《名录》本身立足于自然保护(the Conservation of Nature)”脱节。

IV ① So what does our deep future hold? ② A growing number of researchers and organisations are now thinking seriously about that question. ③ For example, the Long Now Foundation has as its **flagship**^① project a **mechanical**^② clock that is designed to still be marking time thousands of years hence.

那么,遥远的未来究竟会是何种景象呢?越来越多的研究者及组织正在认真思考这个问题。比如,今日永存基金会就将一台旨在数千年之后仍然能够记录时间的机械时钟作为其旗舰项目。

· 词汇注释与难句分析 ·

① **flagship** ['flæɡʃɪp] *n.* 旗舰

② **mechanical** [mɪ'kænikəl] *a.* 机械的

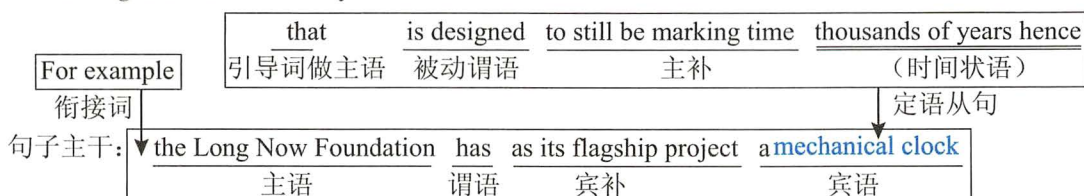
● 经典搭配

① flagship project (旗舰项目)

② mark time (计时)

③ thousands of years hence (此后数千年)

For example, the Long Now Foundation has as its flagship project a mechanical clock that is designed to still be marking time thousands of years hence.



功能注释:本句采用 have X as Y 让 X 成为 Y 结构说明今日永久基金会的举措;主干中的宾语 a mechanical clock 由于被 that 定语从句修饰,而宾语补足语 as its flagship project 略短,故宾补被提至宾语之前,成为 have as Y X 的结构;that 定语从句补充说明 a mechanical clock 的功用。

· 语篇分析 ·

第四至六段阐释如何正确、理性地思考未来。

第四段承上启下指出:越来越多的人开始认真思考遥远的未来。关键词为:think seriously。

①句设问:人类遥远的未来究竟会如何? So(那么 [用以提出新话题、疑问、评论等])将全文一分为二,上文驳论“两种对未来的想象(均不可取)”,提示下文开启“立论”,说明应如何看待未来;hold 此处取僻义,用以说明将来会发生的情况(used to show what may happen in the future)。

②③句介绍现状“人们开始重视对未来的探索”并举例证。has as its flagship project a mechanical clock 为 have sth as sth(使……成为……)的变体,还原后为 has a mechanical clock as its flagship project,补语成分 as...前置意在凸显基金会对这一机械钟项目的高度重视(flagship project 意为 the most important project)。定语从句中 is designed to(=be made for a particular purpose“旨在”)强调建造此钟有特定用途;hence 语用功能为 used to refer to a time in the future, esp. a long time in the future“此后(很长时间)”,thousands of years hence 表示“(从现在起)数千年之后(的漫长时期)”,与 still 一起,说明此项目立足长远,深猷远计(今日永存基金会以“超越目前视域局限,关注人类长远未来”为宗旨,详见背景知识)。

【深层解读】本段为过渡段,看似并无太多实质信息,但“越来越多的人开始严肃思考未来”聚焦于“科研人员及机构”,表明如今的大趋势是“以科学、严谨的态度来考量未来”,这就与上述人们的不理智形成反差,为后文具体论述做准备。另外,段末 thousands of years hence 与上段“人类从短期来看并无危机(完全无需过度悲观)”暗合,表明“遥远的未来”才是作者真正想提请人们关注和探究的对象。